



RIPHAH
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Meaning and role of Ethics in building a holistic personality

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Meaning and role of Ethics in building a holistic personality

- a) Ethics at individual and social level
- b) Common ethical concerns
- c) Universal Ethical values of Islam
- d) Ethics in an age of science and technology



Objectives of the lecture

- To know the role of ethics on individual and social life
- To learn the common ethical concerns
- To understand the universal ethical values of Islam
- To highlight the importance of ethics in an age of science and technology



Meaning and Origin of Ethics and Morality

- Ethics (Greek *ethikos*) is defined as philosophical study of moral life.
- Ethos refers to totality of conceptions held by a community in relation to ethics.
- Morals and morality refer to manners observed by a specific community, reasoned knowledge of what is considered ethical.
- Morals also mean habitual conduct or behavior of a society, moral sanctions and principles imposed on people in a society.

- J Grooten and G. Jo Steenberger, ed.

New Encyclopedia of Philosophy, New York, p 136, p278.



Definition of Ethics

- Ethics may be defined as “ the normative science of the conduct of human beings living in societies – a science which judges this conduct to be right or wrong, to be good or bad....”
 - ✓ William Lille, *An Introduction to Ethics*, London, Methuen and Co Ltd, 1971, p 1-2
- Ethics as a science provides a systematic body of norms, values, and principles which help in regulating human conduct in society.



Meanings of Ethics in Islamic Tradition

- The word *khuluq* (خُلُق) which means Ethics, denotes a comprehensive term that covers the moral and behavioral aspects of a person.
- Literal meaning of Ethics (الْخُلُق): habits, natures, behaviors, customs.

See: Al-Qamoos al-muheet: Ferozabadi, pg:881.

- Conventionally it means: “the condition of human conduct in which the actions of human being come out easily and with out any trouble or affection”.

Attaarifaat : jurjaani, pg:101.



Ethics at individual and social level

The real importance of a person is shown through his moral and ethical behavior, following are the very basic and fundamental ethical values which must be found in a holistic personality.

- 1) Truthfulness & Honesty
- 2) Knowledge
- 3) Modesty
- 4) Mercy & Kindness
- 5) Patience
- 6) Justice (*Al-ad'l*)

In the coming slides we shall have a brief look on how Quran and Sunnah present these values to form the moral character of a Holistic personality.

(For detail see: , Muslim's Character, Muhammad Al-Ghazali)



Ethics at individual and social level

- **Truthfulness & Honesty**

- ﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ وَكُونُوا مَعَ الصَّادِقِينَ﴾ سورة التوبة: 119

- Believers! Have fear of Allah and stand with those that are truthful.

- عَنْ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ أَبِي أَوْفَى، قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: " الْمُؤْمِنُ يُطْبَعُ عَلَى كُلِّ خُلُقٍ إِلَّا الْكَذِبَ، وَالْخِيَانَةَ ". شعب الإيمان للبيهقي. (4846)

- A believer has all kinds of natures save treachery and telling lie.

- لَا إِيمَانَ لِمَنْ لَا أَمَانَةَ لَهُ، وَلَا دِينَ لِمَنْ لَا عَهْدَ لَهُ . مسند أحمد. (12384)

- “He who is not trustworthy has no faith, and he who does not keep his covenant has no religion.”



Ethics at individual and social level

- Importance of knowledge for a Holistic personality
- ﴿قُلْ هَلْ يَسْتَوِي الَّذِينَ يَعْلَمُونَ وَالَّذِينَ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ﴾ سورة الزمر: 9
- Say, 'O Prophet,' “Are those who know equal to those who do not know?
- قال النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَقُولُ: «مَنْ يُرِدِ اللَّهُ بِهِ خَيْرًا يُفَقِّهْهُ فِي الدِّينِ، وَإِنَّمَا أَنَا قَاسِمٌ وَاللَّهُ يُعْطِي. متفق عليه
- “When Allah wishes good for anyone, He instructs him in the religion. I am only a distributor; Allah gives.” (Sahih Bukhari, hadith no: 71)



Ethics at individual and social level

Role of Modesty in Holistic personality الحياء

﴿وَلَا تَقْرُبُوا الْفَوَاحِشَ مَا ظَهَرَ مِنْهَا وَمَا بَطَنَ﴾. سورة الأنعام: 151.

Do not come near indecencies, openly or secretly.

قَالَ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: إِنَّ مِمَّا أَدْرَكَ النَّاسُ مِنْ كَلَامِ النَّبِيِّ، إِذَا لَمْ تَسْتَحْيَ فَاصْنَعْ مَا شِئْتَ. صحيح البخاري. (3483)

- "One of the admonitions of the previous Prophets which has been conveyed to people is that if you have no modesty, you can do whatever you like."



Ethics at individual and social level

Value of persistence & patience

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اسْتَعِينُوا بِالصَّبْرِ وَالصَّلَاةِ إِنَّ اللَّهَ مَعَ الصَّابِرِينَ﴾ سورة البقرة: 153.

- Believers! Seek help in patience and in Prayer; Allah is with those that are patient.

قَالَ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: وَمَنْ يَتَصَبَّرْ يُصْبِرْهُ اللَّهُ وَمَا أُعْطِيَ أَحَدٌ عَطَاءً هُوَ خَيْرٌ وَأَوْسَعُ مِنَ الصَّبْرِ. مؤطاً الإمام مالك. (7)

Whoever tries to be patient, Allah will give him patience, and no one is given a better or vaster gift than patience.



Ethics at individual and social level

Mercy and Kindness

﴿فَبِمَا رَحْمَةٍ مِنَ اللَّهِ لِنْتَ لَهُمْ وَلَوْ كُنْتَ فَظًّا غَلِيظَ الْقَلْبِ لَانْفَضُّوا مِنْ حَوْلِكَ فَاعْفُ عَنْهُمْ وَاسْتَغْفِرْ لَهُمْ وَشَاوِرْهُمْ فِي الْأَمْرِ فَإِذَا عَزَمْتَ فَتَوَكَّلْ عَلَى اللَّهِ إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُحِبُّ الْمُتَوَكِّلِينَ﴾ سورة آل عمران: 159.

It was thanks to Allah's mercy that you were gentle to them. Had you been rough, hard-hearted, they would surely have scattered away from you. So, pardon them, and pray for their forgiveness, and take counsel from them in matters of importance. And when you are resolved on a course of action place your trust in Allah; surely Allah loves those who put their trust (in Him).

• قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: مَنْ لَا يَرْحَمُ لَا يُرْحَمُ. صحيح البخاري. (5997)

He who is not merciful to others, will not be treated mercifully.



Ethics at individual and social level

Ethics with Family members

﴿وَعَاشِرُوهُنَّ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ فَإِنْ كَرِهْتُمُوهُنَّ فَعَسَى أَنْ تَكْرَهُوا شَيْئًا وَيَجْعَلَ اللَّهُ فِيهِ خَيْرًا كَثِيرًا﴾ سورة النساء: 19

Live with your wives in a good manner. If you dislike them in any manner, it may be that you dislike something in which Allah has placed much good for you.

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: خَيْرُكُمْ خَيْرُكُمْ لِأَهْلِهِ، وَأَنَا خَيْرُكُمْ لِأَهْلِي. سنن ابن ماجه.

The best of you is the one who is best to his wife, and I am the best of you to my wives.



Ethics at individual and social level

Facing hardships with resolution

﴿يَا بُنَيَّ أَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ وَأْمُرْ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ وَانْهَ عَنِ الْمُنْكَرِ وَأَصْبِرْ عَلَىٰ مَا أَصَابَكَ إِنَّ ذَٰلِكَ مِنْ عَزَمِ الْأُمُورِ﴾ سورة لقمان: 17.

“..... And bear with patient constancy whatever may befall you, for this is firmness (of purpose) in (the conduct of affairs).”

﴿وَأَصْبِرْ عَلَىٰ مَا يَقُولُونَ وَاهْجُرْهُمْ هَجْرًا جَمِيلًا﴾ سورة المزمل: 10.

And have patience with what they say, and leave them with noble (dignity)



Ethics at individual and social level

Incorporation of Social and moral values

﴿وَاتِ ذَا الْقُرْبَىٰ حَقَّهُ وَالْمِسْكِينَ وَابْنَ السَّبِيلِ وَلَا تَبْذِرْ تَبْذِيرًا (26) إِنَّ الْمُبْذِرِينَ كَانُوا إِخْوَانَ الشَّيَاطِينِ وَكَانَ الشَّيْطَانُ لِرَبِّهِ كَفُورًا (27) وَإِمَّا تُعْرِضَنَّ عَنْهُمْ ابْتِغَاءَ رَحْمَةٍ مِنْ رَبِّكَ تَرْجُوهَا فَقُلْ لَهُمْ قَوْلًا مَيْسُورًا (28) وَلَا تَجْعَلْ يَدَكَ مَغْلُولَةً إِلَىٰ عُنُقِكَ وَلَا تَبْسُطْهَا كُلَّ الْبَسْطِ فَتَقْعُدَ مَلُومًا مَحْسُورًا (29)﴾ سورة الإسراء.

- Concept of Wealth and its Circulation in the Society
- Wasting money is like assisting Satan
- Showing kindness to the Poor

(<https://tafheemulquran.org/tafhim/bani-israel/page:610>)



Ethics at individual and social level

Importance of life, honour & wealth in social dealings

﴿وَلَا تَقْتُلُوا أَوْلَادَكُمْ خَشْيَةً إِمْلَاقٍ نَحْنُ نَرْزُقُهُمْ وَإِيَّاكُمْ إِنَّ قَتْلَهُمْ كَانَ خِطْئًا كَبِيرًا﴾ (31) وَلَا تَقْرَبُوا الزَّانَا إِنَّهُ كَانَ فَاحِشَةً وَسَاءَ سَبِيلًا
(32) وَلَا تَقْرَبُوا مَالَ الْيَتِيمِ إِلَّا بِالَّتِي هِيَ أَحْسَنُ حَتَّىٰ يَبْلُغَ أَشُدَّهُ وَأَوْفُوا بِالْعَهْدِ إِنَّ الْعَهْدَ كَانَ مَسْئُولًا﴾ (34) سورة الإسراء.

- Filicide (Killing one's own Children)
- Hunger and Starvation
- Adultery and its Sources
- Keeping the promises and Covenant

([https://tafheemulquran.org/tafhim/bani-israel/page: 612–613](https://tafheemulquran.org/tafhim/bani-israel/page:612-613))



Ethics at individual and social level

Mercy and Kindness in Social Dealings

﴿وَأَوْفُوا الْكَيْلَ إِذَا كِلْتُمْ وَزِنُوا بِالْقِسْطَاسِ الْمُسْتَقِيمِ ذَلِكَ خَيْرٌ وَأَحْسَنُ تَأْوِيلًا (35) وَلَا تَقْفُ مَا لَيْسَ لَكَ بِهِ عِلْمٌ إِنَّ السَّمْعَ وَالْبَصَرَ وَالْفُؤَادَ كُلُّ أُولَئِكَ كَانَ عَنْهُ مَسْئُولًا (36) وَلَا تَمْشِ فِي الْأَرْضِ مَرَحًا إِنَّكَ لَن تَخْرِقَ الْأَرْضَ وَلَن تَبْلُغَ الْجِبَالَ طُولًا (37)﴾ سورة الإسراء.

- Humility and Humbleness
- Don't be Arrogant and Walk humbly
- Accountability on the Day of Judgement

([https://tafheemulquran.org/tafhim/bani-israel/page: 615–616](https://tafheemulquran.org/tafhim/bani-israel/page:615-616))

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: رَحِمَ اللَّهُ رَجُلًا سَمَحًا إِذَا بَاعَ، وَإِذَا اشْتَرَى، وَإِذَا اقْتَضَى. صحيح البخاري. (2076)

"May Allah show mercy to a man who adopts a kind attitude when he sells, buys and demands for the repayment of loans."



Ethics at individual and social level

A Productive Holistic Personality

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: «مَنْ نَفَسَ عَنْ مُؤْمِنٍ كُرْبَةً مِنْ كُرْبِ الدُّنْيَا، نَفَسَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ كُرْبَةً مِنْ كُرْبِ يَوْمِ الْقِيَامَةِ، وَمَنْ يَسَّرَ عَلَى مُعْسِرٍ، يَسِّرَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ، وَمَنْ سَتَرَ مُسْلِمًا، سَتَرَهُ اللَّهُ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ، وَاللَّهُ فِي عَوْنِ الْعَبْدِ مَا كَانَ الْعَبْدُ فِي عَوْنِ أَخِيهِ. صحيح مسلم (2699)

If anyone relieves a Muslim believer from one of the hardships of this worldly life, Allah will relieve him of one of the hardships of the Day of Resurrection. If anyone makes it easy for the one who is indebted to him (while finding it difficult to repay), Allah will make it easy for him in this worldly life and in the Hereafter, and if anyone conceals the faults of a Muslim, Allah will conceal his faults in this world and in the Hereafter. Allah helps His slave as long as he helps his brother.



Common ethical concerns

﴿إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْمُرُ بِالْعَدْلِ وَالْإِحْسَانِ وَإِيتَاءِ ذِي الْقُرْبَىٰ وَيَنْهَىٰ عَنِ الْفَحْشَاءِ وَالْمُنْكَرِ وَالْبَغْيِ يَعِظُكُمْ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَذَكَّرُونَ﴾ سورة النحل: 90

Surely Allah enjoins justice, kindness and the doing of good to kith and kin, and forbids all that is shameful, evil and oppressive. He exhorts you so that you may be mindful.

الْفَحْشَاءُ = Things that are immodest, immoral, obscene, nasty, dirty, vulgar, not fit to be seen or heard

الْمُنْكَرِ = Applies to all those evils which have always been universally regarded as evils and have been forbidden by all divine systems of law.

وَالْبَغْيِ = Applies to those vices that transgress the proper limits of decency and violate the rights of others, whether those of the Creator or His Creation.

(<https://tafheemulquran.org/tafhim/an-nahal/> page:564-566.



Common ethical concerns

Reasons of Social Disorder and Misconduct

﴿ يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا يَسْخَرُ قَوْمٌ مِنْ قَوْمٍ عَسَىٰ أَنْ يَكُونُوا خَيْرًا مِنْهُمْ وَلَا نِسَاءٌ مِنْ نِسَاءٍ عَسَىٰ أَنْ يَكُنَّ خَيْرًا مِنْهُنَّ وَلَا تَلْمِزُوا أَنْفُسَكُمْ وَلَا تَنَابَزُوا بِالْأَلْقَابِ بِئْسَ الْإِسْمُ الْفُسُوقُ بَعْدَ الْإِيمَانِ وَمَنْ لَمْ يَتُبْ فَأُولَٰئِكَ هُمُ الظَّالِمُونَ (11) يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اجْتَنِبُوا كَثِيرًا مِّنَ الظَّنِّ إِنَّ بَعْضَ الظَّنِّ إِثْمٌ وَلَا تَجَسَّسُوا وَلَا يَغْتَبَ بَعْضُكُم بَعْضًا أَيُحِبُّ أَحَدُكُمْ أَنْ يَأْكُلَ لَحْمَ أَخِيهِ مَيْتًا فَكَرِهْتُمُوهُ وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ إِنَّ اللَّهَ تَوَّابٌ رَّحِيمٌ (12) ﴾ سورة الحجرات.

Believers, let not a group (of men) scoff at another group, it may well be that the latter (at whom they scoff) are better than they; nor let a group of women scoff at another group, it may well be that the latter are better than they. And do not taunt one another, nor revile one another by nicknames. It is an evil thing to gain notoriety for ungodliness after belief. Those who do not repent are indeed the wrong-doers. Believers, avoid being excessively suspicious, for some suspicion is a sin. Do not spy, nor backbite one another. Would any of you like to eat the flesh of his dead brother? You would surely detest it. Have fear of Allah. Surely Allah is much prone to accept repentance, is Most Compassionate.

See for detail: (<https://tafheemulquran.org/tafhim/al-hujrat/> page:84-98).



Common ethical concerns

Breaking ties of relationship

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: لَا يَدْخُلُ الْجَنَّةَ قَاطِعٌ. صحيح البخاري. (5984)

“The one who severs the ties of kinship will not enter Paradise.”

Pride and Arrogance

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: لَا يَدْخُلُ الْجَنَّةَ مَنْ كَانَ فِي قَلْبِهِ مِثْقَالُ ذَرَّةٍ مِنْ كِبَرٍ. صحيح مسلم. (91)

He who has in his heart the weight of a mustard seed of pride shall not enter Paradise.



Common ethical concerns

Prohibition of adultery, intoxicant, stealing and robbery

قَالَ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: «لَا يَزْنِي الزَّانِي حِينَ يَزْنِي وَهُوَ مُؤْمِنٌ، وَلَا يَشْرَبُ الْخَمْرَ حِينَ يَشْرَبُ وَهُوَ مُؤْمِنٌ، وَلَا يَسْرِقُ حِينَ يَسْرِقُ وَهُوَ مُؤْمِنٌ، وَلَا يَنْتَهِبُ نُهْبَةً، يَرْفَعُ النَّاسُ إِلَيْهِ أَبْصَارَهُمْ حِينَ يَنْتَهِبُهَا وَهُوَ مُؤْمِنٌ. صحيح البخاري: (2475).

The Prophet (ﷺ) said, "When an adulterer commits illegal sexual intercourse, then he is not a believer at the time, he is doing it, and when a drinker of an alcoholic liquor drinks it, then he is not a believer at the time of drinking it, and when a thief steals, then he is not a believer at the time of stealing, and when a robber robs, and the people look at him, then he is not a believer at the time of doing robbery.



Universal Ethical values of Islam

Following are the universal Islamic teachings that never changeable by any mean.

1. Unity in Life and Cosmos (tawhid)
2. Equity, Justice, Fairness ('adl)
3. Protection and Promotion of Life (nafs)
4. Protection of Reason ('aql)
5. Preservation of Religio-Cultural Freedom (din)
6. Protection and Dignity of Gene and Genealogy (nasl)
7. Protection of Property (mal)

(for detail see: A Global Ethics for a Globalized World by Dr. Anis Ahmad; <https://www.jstor.org/stable/pdf/42909298.pdf>)



Manifestation of Tawhid in Ethical Behavior

• ﴿لَوْ كَانَ فِيهِمَا آلِهَةٌ إِلَّا اللَّهُ لَفَسَدَتَا فَسُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَرْشِ عَمَّا يَصِفُونَ﴾ سورة الأنبياء: 22

“Had there been any gods in the heavens and the earth apart from Allah, the order of both the heaven and the earth would have gone to ruins...”

﴿وَلَقَدْ بَعَثْنَا فِي كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ رَسُولًا أَنْ اعْبُدُوا اللَّهَ وَاجْتَنِبُوا الطَّاغُوتَ﴾ سورة النحل: 36.

We raised a Messenger in every community (to tell them): "Serve Allah and shun the Evil One.

﴿وَلَا تَدْعُ مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ مَا لَا يَنْفَعُكَ وَلَا يَضُرُّكَ فَإِنْ فَعَلْتَ فَإِنَّكَ إِذَا مِنَ الظَّالِمِينَ﴾ سورة يونس: 106

Do not call upon any apart from Allah on those who have no power to benefit or hurt you. For if you call upon others than Allah you will be reckoned among the wrong-doers.



Establishing ‘*adl* (justice) in all spheres of life

Commanding Justice and Conveying the Witness for Allah Al-Mighty

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا كُونُوا قَوَّامِينَ بِالْقِسْطِ شُهَدَاءَ لِلَّهِ وَلَوْ عَلَى أَنْفُسِكُمْ أَوِ الْوَالِدَيْنِ وَالْأَقْرَبِينَ إِن يَكُنْ غَنِيًّا أَوْ فَقِيرًا فَاللَّهُ أَوْلَىٰ بِهِمَا فَلَا تَتَّبِعُوا الْهَوَىٰ أَنْ تَعْدِلُوا وَإِنْ تَلُوتُوا أَوْ تَعْرِضُوا فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ كَانِ بِمَا تَعْمَلُونَ خَبِيرًا﴾ سورة النساء: 135.

Believers! Be upholders of justice, and bearers of witness to truth for the sake of Allah, even though it may either be against yourselves or against your parents and kinsmen, or the rich or the poor: for Allah is more concerned with their well-being than you are. Do not, then, follow your own desires lest you keep away from justice. If you twist or turn away from (the truth), know that Allah is well aware of all that you do.

(For detail see: <https://tafheemulquran.org/tafhim/an-nisa/> page:406-407).



Value of life: Preservation and promotion of life

﴿وَلَا تَقْتُلُوا النَّفْسَ الَّتِي حَرَّمَ اللَّهُ إِلَّا بِالْحَقِّ وَمَنْ قُتِلَ مَظْلُومًا فَقَدْ جَعَلْنَا لَوْلِيَّهِ سُلْطَانًا فَلَا يُسْرِفُ فِي الْقَتْلِ إِنَّهُ كَانَ مَنْصُورًا﴾
سورة الإسراء: 33

Do not kill any person whom Allah has forbidden to kill, except with right. We have granted the heir of him who has been wrongfully killed the authority to (claim retribution); so let him not exceed in slaying. He shall be helped.

﴿مَنْ أَجَلَ ذَلِكَ كَتَبْنَا عَلَى بَنِي إِسْرَائِيلَ أَنَّهُ مَنْ قَتَلَ نَفْسًا بِغَيْرِ نَفْسٍ أَوْ فَسَادٍ فِي الْأَرْضِ فَكَأَنَّمَا قَتَلَ النَّاسَ جَمِيعًا وَمَنْ أَحْيَاهَا فَكَأَنَّمَا أَحْيَا النَّاسَ جَمِيعًا﴾ سورة المائدة: 32.

Therefore, We ordained for the Children of Israel⁵³ that he who slays a soul unless it be (in punishment) for murder or for spreading mischief on earth shall be as if he had slain all mankind; and he who saves a life shall be as if he had given life to all mankind

(<https://tafheemulquran.org/tafhim/bani-israel/> page: 614).



Value of reason

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِنَّمَا الْخَمْرُ وَالْمَيْسِرُ وَالْأَنْصَابُ وَالْأَزْلَامُ رِجْسٌ مِنْ عَمَلِ الشَّيْطَانِ فَاجْتَنِبُوهُ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُفْلِحُونَ﴾ سورة المائدة: 90

Believers! Intoxicants, games of chance, idolatrous sacrifices at altars, and divining arrows are all abominations, the handiwork of Satan. So, turn wholly away from it that you may attain to true success.

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: كُلُّ مُسْكِرٍ، حَرَامٌ، وَمَا أَسْكَرَ كَثِيرُهُ، فَقَلِيلُهُ حَرَامٌ. سنن ابن ماجه.
(3392)

Every intoxicant is unlawful and whatever causes intoxication in large amounts, a small amount of it is (also) unlawful.

(for detail see: A Global Ethics for a Globalized World by Dr. Anis Ahmad; page:72.
<https://www.jstor.org/stable/pdf/42909298.pdf>)



Value of Religious and Cultural freedom

- Co-existence and plurality

﴿لَكُمْ دِينُكُمْ وَلِيَ دِينِ﴾ سورة الكافرون: 6

For you is your Faith, and for me, my faith.

﴿لَا إِكْرَاهَ فِي الدِّينِ﴾ سورة البقرة: 256.

There is no compulsion in Faith.

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: مَنْ بَدَّلَ دِينَهُ فَاقْتُلُوهُ. صحيح البخاري (3017)

He who changes his religion (i.e., apostates) kill him.



Value of ownership

﴿وَأَتُوا الْيَتَامَىٰ أَمْوَالَهُمْ وَلَا تَتَبَدَّلُوا الْخَبِيثَ بِالطَّيِّبِ وَلَا تَأْكُلُوا أَمْوَالَهُمْ إِلَىٰ أَمْوَالِكُمْ إِنَّهُ كَانَ حُوبًا كَبِيرًا﴾ سورة النساء: 2

Give orphans their property, and do not exchange the bad for the good, and do not eat up their property by mixing it with your own. This surely is a mighty sin.

﴿وَلَا تُؤْتُوا السُّفَهَاءَ أَمْوَالَكُمُ الَّتِي جَعَلَ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ قِيَامًا﴾ سورة النساء: 5.

Do not entrust your properties - which Allah has made a means of support for you - to the weak of understanding.

Islam at a Glance, page:107.

<https://www.islamicstudies.info/literature/glance.htm#a12>



Ethics in an age of science and technology

Obligation of learning beneficial sciences and skills

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: الْكَلِمَةُ الْحِكْمَةُ ضَالَّةُ الْمُؤْمِنِ، فَحَيْثُ وَجَدَهَا فَهُوَ أَحَقُّ بِهَا. سنن الترمذي (2687)

"The wise statement is the lost property of the believer, so wherever he finds it, then he is more worthy of it."



Ethics in an age of science and technology

Pure Intention and sincerity for the service of whole humanity

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: خَيْرُ النَّاسِ أَنْفَعُهُمْ لِلنَّاسِ. المعجم الصغير للطبراني: (5787)

The best of people are those who are most beneficial to people.

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: اللَّهُمَّ إِنِّي أَسْأَلُكَ عِلْمًا نَافِعًا. سنن ابن ماجه (925)

O Allah, I ask You for knowledge that is of benefit.



Ethics in an age of science and technology

The strong and optimistic Muslim

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: «الْمُؤْمِنُ الْقَوِيُّ، خَيْرٌ وَأَحَبُّ إِلَى اللَّهِ مِنَ الْمُؤْمِنِ الضَّعِيفِ، وَفِي كُلِّ خَيْرٍ احْرَصْ عَلَى مَا يَنْفَعُكَ، وَاسْتَعِزْ بِاللَّهِ وَلَا تَعْجِزْ، وَإِنْ أَصَابَكَ شَيْءٌ، فَلَا تَقُلْ لَوْ أَنِّي فَعَلْتُ كَذَا وَكَذَا، وَلَكِنْ قُلْ قَدَرُ اللَّهِ وَمَا شَاءَ فَعَلَ، فَإِنْ لَوْ تَفْتَحْ عَمَلَ الشَّيْطَانِ» صحيح مسلم: (2664)

"A strong believer is better and dearer to Allah than a weak one, and both are good. Adhere to that which is beneficial for you. Keep asking Allah for help and do not refrain from it. If you are afflicted in any way, do not say: 'If I had taken this or that step, it would have resulted into such and such,' but say only: 'Allah so determined and did as He willed.' The word 'if' opens the gates of satanic thoughts".



Ethics in an age of science and technology

The golden rule

Regard your competitors' Interest/gain as your own gain, and your competitors' loss as your own loss.

This maxim is expressed in the Hadith of the Prophet (pbuh) and is a basis for ethics, rights, or morality in innumerable settings.

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: لَا يُؤْمِنُ أَحَدُكُمْ، حَتَّى يُحِبَّ لِأَخِيهِ مَا يُحِبُّ لِنَفْسِهِ. صحيح البخاري (13)

Treat other people the way you would like to be treated with respect!



Ethics in an age of science and technology

Really applying the Golden Rule

Notice that the golden rule requires us to make a definite act of imagination. We need to imagine things from the other's point of view and feel their loss or their gain.

"You never really understand a person, until you consider things from his point of view... Until you climb inside of his skin and walk around in it."

For detail see: (The Islamic Vision of Life, (Religion & Modern Era, Vol. I, Page: 49-54. By Khurshid Ahmad)



The Quranic Model for the Holistic personality

- ﴿لَيْسَ الْبِرُّ أَنْ تُوَلُّوا وُجُوهَكُمْ قِبَلَ الْمَشْرِقِ وَالْمَغْرِبِ وَلَكِنَّ الْبِرَّ مَنْ آمَنَ بِاللَّهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةِ وَالْكِتَابِ وَالنَّبِيِّينَ وَآتَى الْمَالَ عَلَى حُبِّهِ ذَوِي الْقُرْبَىٰ وَالْيَتَامَىٰ وَالْمَسَاكِينَ وَابْنَ السَّبِيلِ وَالسَّائِلِينَ وَفِي الرِّقَابِ وَأَقَامَ الصَّلَاةَ وَآتَى الزَّكَاةَ وَالْمُوفُونَ بِعَهْدِهِمْ إِذَا عَاهَدُوا وَالصَّابِرِينَ فِي الْبَأْسَاءِ وَالضَّرَّاءِ وَحِينَ الْبَأْسِ أُولَٰئِكَ الَّذِينَ صَدَقُوا وَأُولَٰئِكَ هُمُ الْمُتَّقُونَ﴾ سورة البقرة: 177

Righteousness does not consist in turning your faces towards the east or towards the west;175 true righteousness consists in believing in Allah and the Last Day, the angels, the Book and the Prophets, and in giving away one's property in love of Him to one's kinsmen, the orphans, the poor and the wayfarer, and to those who ask for help, and in freeing the necks of slaves, and in establishing Prayer and dispensing the Zakah. True righteousness is attained by those who are faithful to their promise once they have made it and by those who remain steadfast in adversity and affliction and at the time of battle (between Truth and falsehood). Such are the truthful ones; such are the God-fearing.



Summary:

Ethical norms and values are not relative but universal and global. Ethics encompasses all human actions and transactions. Islamic ethics differ from the Western concept as these are derived from God, directly from the Quran, and from the practices of the Holy Prophet (PBUH). It is therefore a set of beliefs and actions that is divine and transcends the limitations of time, place and tradition. According to Islam, there is universal equality among mankind, with the single exception of moral goodness and strength of character or *taqwa*. Islamic ethics is a code of conduct that calls mankind to undertake a continuous process of self-purification in thoughts, feelings and emotions. In Islam, ethics is founded on Divine directives (*awamir*), commands (*ahkam*) and principles (*usul*). Islamic ethics are applied and natural. It inculcates universal values of truth (*haqq*), honesty (*sadaqat*), perseverance (*sabr*), justice (‘*adl*), and excellence (*itqan*).



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